

Business Structure Efficiency

A digital operating model where information is captured once, flows between systems on its own, and AI does the drafting — leaving review and approval as the only manual steps.

11

platforms already in use — the plan adds almost nothing

9

review areas answered, meeting workflow first

8 Sep

final delivery · architecture 25 Aug

Responds to *Project Brief — Business Structure Efficiency*, 28 July 2026. This is the draft plan; the schematic architecture follows on 25 August.

What the brief asks for

Maximise time spent consulting. Minimise administration.

Stated outcomes

- Single point of data entry wherever possible
- Minimal duplication across systems
- Maximum use of AI for administrative tasks
- Highly automated document creation
- Automated meeting documentation
- Automated project administration, filing and organisation
- High-quality draft emails and reports needing only review
- Consistent processes, scalable, secure

The binding constraint

“Confined to the shared capability of the following tools without need for third-party management platform.”

This is the most important line in the brief. It rules out Monday, Notion, Asana, Zapier and every other SaaS layer. The design therefore uses what is already licensed, joined by automation you own and can hand over.

Section 9 still asks for software recommendations — answered, but deliberately short.

Draft Plan

11 Aug 2026 — this document

Schematic Architecture

25 Aug 2026

Final

8 Sep 2026

Eleven platforms, no connective tissue

Every platform is capable. None of them talk to each other, so the consultant is the integration layer.

PLATFORM	ROLE TODAY	WHERE THE EFFORT GOES	VERDICT
Microsoft 365 — Outlook, Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive, Office, Copilot	Email, meetings, files, documents	Notes typed by hand, files named and filed by hand, actions tracked in memory	Backbone
HubSpot	CRM, pipeline	Contacts and deal stages re-entered from email threads	Source of truth
ProjectManager	Projects, tasks	Tasks retyped from meeting outcomes	Source of truth
Xero	Invoicing, accounts	Invoice triggers watched manually against project milestones	Source of truth
Canva	Proposals, reports, presentations	Rebuilt from scratch each time; content re-keyed	Template gap
Claude / Copilot	Drafting assistance	Context pasted in by hand every session; nothing is remembered	Under-used
WordPress · LinkedIn	Website, market presence	Content written ad hoc, publishing irregular	Manual
Adobe PDF · Chrome	Documents, browsing	Fine as-is	No change

Current State Assessment is a named deliverable; this is its summary. The full assessment lands with the final on 8 September, after a working session to confirm volumes and actual time spent.

The same fact gets entered four times

A single client conversation currently produces manual work in four places, because nothing carries information forward:

MEETING

Discussion happens **notes typed by hand**

HUBSPOT

Contact and stage updated **re-entered**

PROJECTMANAGER

Actions become tasks **re-entered**

OUTLOOK

Follow-up written **written from scratch**

SHAREPOINT

Documents filed **named and moved by hand**

The principle

Capture once. Distribute automatically. Review at the end, not throughout.

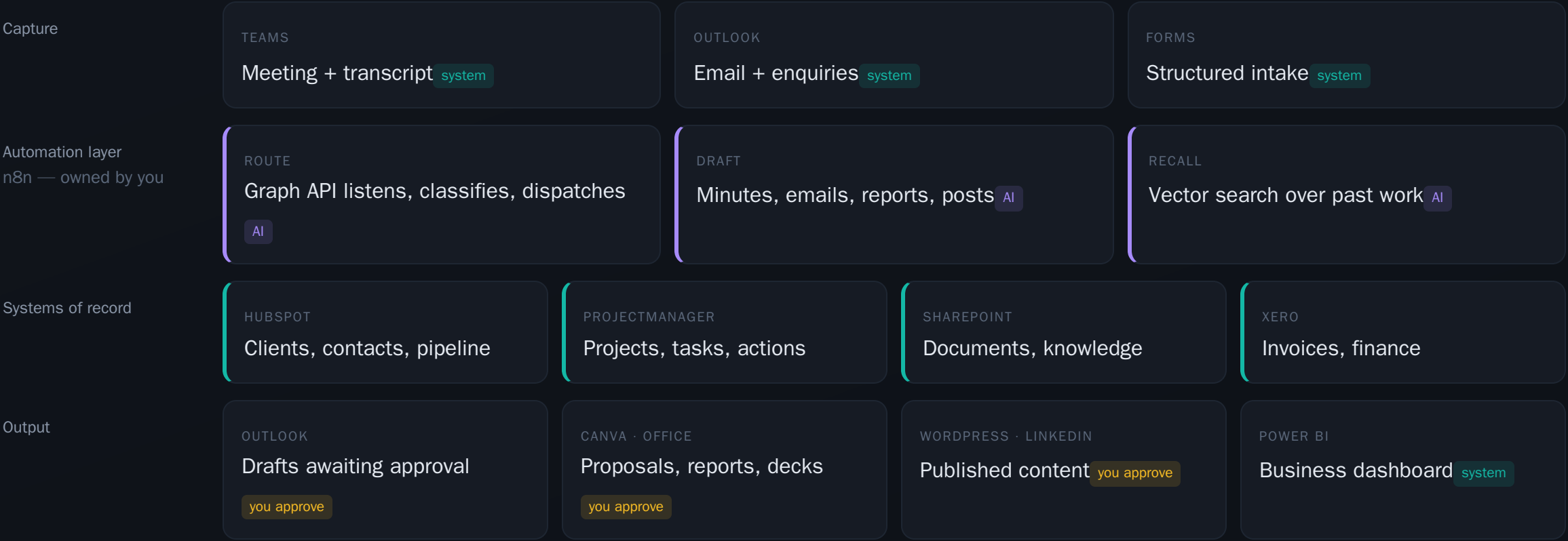
The meeting already produces a recording and a transcript. Everything above can be derived from it — which makes the meeting workflow the highest-leverage place to start, and the brief already names it as the top priority.

What this is not

Not autonomous sending. Every outbound artefact — email, proposal, invoice trigger — stops at a draft for approval. The brief asks for “review and refinement and final approval”, and the design keeps that gate everywhere it touches a client.

Business Systems Integration Diagram

Which system owns which fact, and how information moves. Full-fidelity version is the 25 August deliverable.



n8n is self-hosted on infrastructure you own — it is the integration layer, not a third-party management platform, which is what keeps the design inside the brief's constraint.

One owner per fact

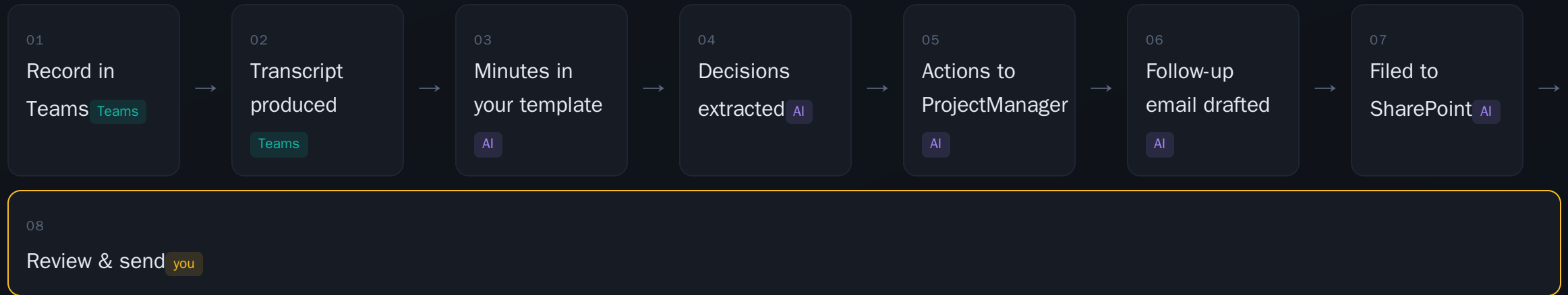
Duplication ends when every type of information has exactly one home and everything else reads from it.

INFORMATION	SOURCE OF TRUTH	FLOWS TO	ENTERED WHERE
Clients & contacts	HubSpot	ProjectManager, Xero, document metadata, mail merge	Once, at onboarding form
Projects & actions	ProjectManager	Meeting minutes, status emails, Power BI	Derived from meetings — not typed
Documents & deliverables	SharePoint	Knowledge base, Canva, proposals, client share links	Filed automatically on creation
Finance	Xero	Power BI, project profitability	Triggered by project milestones
Meetings & decisions	Teams + SharePoint	Minutes, actions, follow-up email, knowledge base	Recording only
Past work & methodology	Knowledge base	Every AI draft, every proposal	Indexed automatically from SharePoint
Market presence	WordPress	LinkedIn, capability statements	Drafted by AI, approved by you

Scalability follows from this table rather than from extra software: adding a second consultant means adding a user, not redesigning the model.

The meeting workflow

“No manual note taking should be required.” One recording produces the minutes, the decisions, the tasks, the follow-up and the filing.



How it is built

Graph API subscribes to meeting-transcript events. n8n pulls the transcript, runs it through the drafting prompt with your minutes template, then writes to ProjectManager, SharePoint and an Outlook draft.

Extends to daily notes

The brief asks that this cover personal brainstorming too. Same pipeline, different template — a voice note or OneNote page in, structured and filed output back.

Open question

Teams transcription must be enabled tenant-wide, and app-only transcript access needs an application access policy. Confirm licensing before 25 August — this is the one place where the plan depends on a setting outside our control.

Email and documents

Email automation

CASE	AI PRODUCES
New client enquiry	Classified, drafted reply, HubSpot contact created
Meeting follow-up	Draft with decisions and actions attached
Project progress update	Draft with status graphic and report attached
Proposal response	Draft built from the closest past proposal
Standard enquiry	Draft from the response library
Reminders	Scheduled from ProjectManager due dates
Commercial email filing	Prompt to file, then filed on confirmation

Everything lands in Outlook Drafts. Nothing sends itself.

Document management

Proposed SharePoint structure — predictable enough that filing can be automatic:

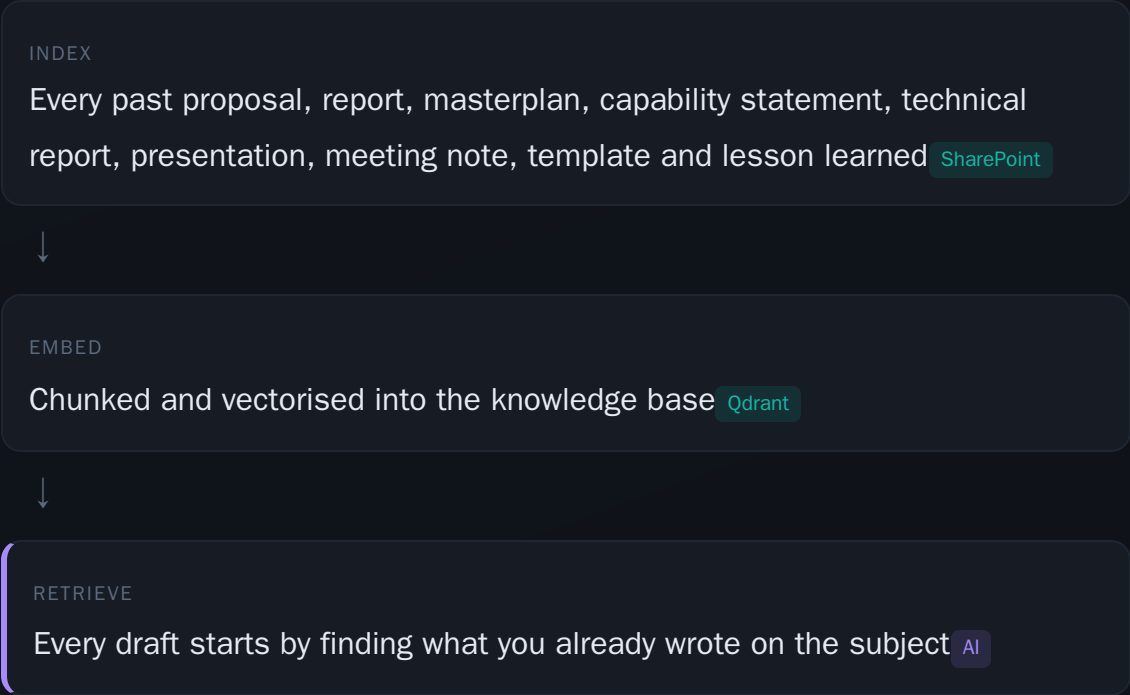
```
/Clients
  /{Client}
    /{ProjectNo}-{ProjectName}
      /01-Proposals
      /02-Meetings
      /03-Deliverables
      /04-Correspondence
      /05-Finance
/Business
  /Capability Statements
  /Templates
  /Methodologies
  /Lessons Learned
```

Naming: {YYYY-MM-DD}_{ProjectNo}_{DocType}_{Rev} — applied by the automation, so it is consistent by construction rather than by discipline.

Version control through SharePoint's own history. Retrieval through the knowledge base on the next slide.

Knowledge management — where AI stops being an assistant

“The objective is to avoid recreating work already completed.” This is the difference between AI that drafts generically and AI that drafts like you.



AI as worker, not assistant	
TASK	TODAY → PROPOSED
Meeting minutes	Manual → AI, you approve
Action extraction	Manual → AI, you approve
Email drafting	Manual → AI, you approve
Proposals & briefs	Manual → AI from past work
Reports	Manual → AI first draft
Presentations	Manual → AI into Canva template
Filing & naming	Manual → fully automatic
Final judgement	You → still you

Marketing and structured capture

Marketing automation

Enquiry handling

Inbound enquiry classified, drafted response, HubSpot contact created, follow-up scheduled.

LinkedIn industry monitoring

Summarising the energy industry's LinkedIn activity — posts, blogs, articles — into a periodic digest.

Flagged: LinkedIn's terms prohibit automated scrolling of the feed, and their API does not expose it. Practical routes are the official Pages API for company content, or a curated source list. Recommend confirming appetite before committing to this one.

Content drafting

Fortnightly LinkedIn posts and blogs drafted from your recent project work and the daily industry report — the two engagements feeding each other.

Forms & data capture

Free text becomes structured input, which is what makes everything downstream automatable.

FORM	FEEDS
Project initiation	PM + SharePoint
Client onboarding	HubSpot + Xero
Site inspection	Report draft
Meeting preparation	Agenda + minutes
Proposal request	Proposal draft
Consultant checklist	Quality record
Stakeholder input	Project record
Design review	Deliverable record
Defect / product issue claim	Issue register
Stakeholder project enquiry	HubSpot

Built in Microsoft Forms — already licensed, native to the tenant, no new platform.

Software recommendations

The brief prefers adding nothing. Three additions are proposed, all self-hosted or already owned — and one thing is explicitly *not* recommended.

ADDITION	JUSTIFICATION	COST	EFFORT	MAINTENANCE
n8n self-hosted	The integration layer. Without it, the platforms cannot talk without a third-party SaaS — which the brief rules out.	~A\$12/mo VPS	Already running	Low — you own it
Vector knowledge base self-hosted	Lets AI draft from your past work instead of generically. This is what makes section 7 real.	Included	Low	Low
AI API	Drafting engine. Claude or Gemini; you already use Claude.	~A\$30–80/mo	Low	None
Power BI Desktop already free	Business dashboard over HubSpot, ProjectManager and Xero.	Free	Medium	Low

Not recommended

A dedicated practice management platform. It would duplicate HubSpot, ProjectManager and Xero, cost more than everything above combined, and re-introduce exactly the third-party dependency the brief asks to avoid.

Worth a decision

Microsoft 365 Business Premium over Standard — adds Intune and better security controls for client data. Relevant to the “secure handling of client and business information” outcome. Modest per-seat increase.

Automation opportunities, ranked

Ordered by return against effort. Effort is build time; maintenance is the ongoing cost once running.

AUTOMATION	INTEGRATION	EFFORT	MAINTENANCE	RETURN
Meeting → minutes, actions, filing, follow-up	Graph (Teams) → n8n → PM, SharePoint, Outlook	High	Low	Highest
Automatic filing & naming	Graph (SharePoint/OneDrive)	Low	Low	High
Email drafting & enquiry triage	Graph (Outlook) → AI → HubSpot	Medium	Low	High
Knowledge base over past work	SharePoint → vector store	Medium	Low	High
Client onboarding, one form	Forms → HubSpot, Xero, PM, SharePoint	Low	Low	Medium
Proposal & report generation	Knowledge base → Canva / Word	High	Medium	High
Project milestone → Xero invoice draft	PM → n8n → Xero	Medium	Low	Medium
Business dashboard	HubSpot, PM, Xero → Power BI	Medium	Low	Medium
LinkedIn monitoring & drafting	Sources → AI → draft posts	Medium	Medium	Conditional

Path to 8 September

11 AUG — TODAY

Draft Plan

This document. Operating model, target architecture, the nine review areas answered, opportunities ranked.

25 AUG

Schematic Architecture

Full Business Systems Integration Diagram, process flow maps per workflow, SharePoint information architecture, integration specifications.

8 SEP

Final

Complete current-state assessment, final architecture, API integration schedule with effort and maintenance, software recommendations, implementation sequence.

What is needed from you between now and 25 August

- Working session, ~90 minutes — walk through a real week so the current-state assessment reflects actual volumes rather than assumption
- Templates — your meeting minutes, proposal and report formats, so the AI drafts into the real thing
- Microsoft 365 tenant confirmation — licensing, and whether Teams transcription is enabled
- Decision on LinkedIn monitoring — scope it to what the platform permits, or drop it
- Sample documents — a representative set of past proposals and reports to seed the knowledge base
- Access — HubSpot private app token, Xero OAuth, ProjectManager API token, when build starts

Risks and open questions

Stated now rather than discovered in September.

RISK	DETAIL	RESPONSE
Teams transcript access	App-only access to meeting transcripts requires the right licensing and an application access policy. If unavailable, the highest-priority workflow needs a different trigger.	Confirm before 25 Aug. Fallback: transcript export on meeting end.
LinkedIn feed monitoring	The brief asks for scrolling all latest posts. The platform's terms prohibit this and the API does not expose the feed.	Rescope to permitted sources, or remove from scope.
Canva automation depth	The Canva API supports asset and template operations but not arbitrary layout generation. Fully automated deck build may be partial.	Prototype during architecture phase; Office fallback.
AI draft quality	Drafts are only as good as the knowledge base behind them. Thin source material means generic output.	Seed with real past work early; measure on real tasks.
Single point of failure	The automation layer becomes business-critical.	Self-hosted with backups; every workflow degrades to the current manual process rather than blocking it.

On scope. Two items in the brief — LinkedIn feed monitoring and full Canva generation — cannot be delivered exactly as written because of platform limits rather than effort. Both are flagged here so the scope can be adjusted deliberately rather than quietly missed.

IN ONE LINE

The business runs itself. You approve it.

Captured once

A meeting, an email or a form is the only input. Nothing is typed twice.

Drafted by AI

Minutes, actions, emails, proposals, reports and posts arrive written, using your past work and your templates.

Approved by you

Every client-facing artefact waits for you. Judgement stays where it belongs.

Draft Plan · Business Structure Efficiency · 11 August 2026 · responds to the project brief dated 28 July 2026

Next: Schematic Architecture Plan, 25 August 2026.